



HUMANITAS  
INSTITUTE

## Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Trinity Christian Academy  
School Website: <https://www.trinitylex.org/>

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**Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer**

*This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.*

ACCS: **STARTUP** SCL: **MEMBER**

*Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) and the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.*

## Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

### Executive Summary

Trinity Christian Academy (KY 40515) presents a discernible classical Christian orientation in public-facing materials, foregrounding Christ-centered education, virtue formation, and a caregiver-partnered community ethos. The school markets itself as Central Kentucky's "premier classical Christian private day school," and its admissions/communications emphasize partnership with families and engagement with church life (including a stated ministry connection to a Presbyterian church). These signals align with elements of the classical model, particularly in its stated aim of forming character and fostering a virtuous, Well-ordered education within a Christian framework. However, while the public materials clearly advertise classical language and frameworks (e.g., "classical Christian private day school"), explicit curricular components that are hallmarks of a full classical curriculum—such as a stated seven liberal arts core (grammar, logic, rhetoric; the Trivium; the Quadrivium), explicit Great Books/Great Conversation pedagogy, and explicit Socratic pedagogy across grades—are not consistently spelled out in the school's publicly accessible content. On balance, the school exhibits a classical Christian orientation and robust parent/community alignment, but with gaps in explicitly documenting certain core classical curriculum and pedagogy tenets across all levels.

Overall rating: **SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL**.

Executive observations and key takeaways:

- Religious and Metaphysical Foundations are present, but strongly framed through a Christ-centered, Christian-school identity, with explicit church-ministry alignment. This signals a robust religious-metaphysical orientation, but the materials do not consistently foreground liturgical practices or explicit theological program beyond the Christ-centered framing. Evidence includes explicit Christ-centered language and a church-affiliation note.
- School Purpose and Goal align with classical-pedagogical aims (formation, virtue, wisdom), anchored in virtue and character formation within a Christian framework. The capital campaign language emphasizes character development and education that forms the person, not merely information.
- Curriculum signals a classical orientation (public materials describe a classical Christian school), but there is limited explicit documentation within the public site content of the canonical Trivium/Quadrivium structure or Great Books enrollment. The absence of explicit Great Books/Great Conversation language in the visible public content is a notable gap for a fully classical taxonomy. See evidence under Element 3.
- Pedagogy is not uniformly documented in classical terms (e.g., Socratic seminars, memory work, scholé days, or extensive upper-school rhetoric programs are not consistently described in the public-facing pages). The lack of explicit Socratic pedagogy as described in the classical rubric contributes to the overall classification of **SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL** rather than **CLASSICAL**.

- Faculty presence appears, with named faculty pages and visible teacher profiles and signs of a mentorship/cultivation culture; however, explicit language about “living curriculum” or classroom practices aligned with classical pedagogy is not consistently documented in the public materials. This again supports a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating for Element 5.
- Parents & Community are foregrounded as partners, with explicit emphasis on family involvement, parent formation, and open-campus/visits. This aligns with the classical element of a strong partnership with families and a shared mission.

Note: The knowledge-base materials (Six Essential Elements) provide explicit keyword indicators for each category (positive and negative). These indicators are used below to ground category scoring with a quantitative methodological approach. See the Six Essential Elements keyword lexicon and indicators for cross-walking the school’s public-facing content to a classical rubric.

## Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

### Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The public materials emphasize a Christ-centered education and classical Christian identity, signaling a religious-metaphysical orientation. For example, Capital Campaign language explicitly frames the school as a “Christ-centered” institution and a “premier classical Christian private day school.” This reflects transcendental aims and a theological framing of education. - A church-affiliation note appears in the employment materials, indicating the school operates within a faith-community context (ministry of a Presbyterian church). This supports a theological grounding in practice.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators from the Six Essential Elements lexicon include truth, goodness, beauty; theology; liturgy; worship; chapel; worship-related culture; and sacred tradition. The visible public content emphasizes Christ-centered and classical Christian identity; however, direct textual instances of terms like theology, liturgy, or worship in the exact keyword lists are not consistently foregrounded in the public-facing pages. This yields a partial positive alignment but not a full, explicit liturgical-theological program on the site. See classical lexicon guidance for the taxonomy of terms.

Why this rating - The religious orientation is undeniable and central to the school’s self-definition (Christ-centered, classical Christian). Yet the absence of explicit liturgical practices, overt theological course structures, and direct usage of certain canonical keywords (e.g., “theology,” “liturgy,” “worship”) in the public-facing materials reduces it from CLASSICAL to SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL in this rubric.

What would move the needle - Add explicit references to liturgical practices (e.g., regular chapel/worship schedule, liturgical calendars) and direct theology integration across core disciplines (with explicit mentions of theology as the mistress science). Include enrollment language for theology-focused courses and a clear doctrinal statement.

Citations - Christ-centered and classical Christian framing on Capital Campaign page. - Ministry connection to a Presbyterian church (employment page).

### Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school situates itself as a Christ-centered, classical Christian institution whose formation aims emphasize character and virtue. Public materials explicitly frame education as formation and a means to cultivate virtue, wisdom, and human flourishing within a Christian framework. The Capital Campaign language emphasizes forming character alongside academic skills. - The institution’s self-description explicitly highlights virtue formation and character development within a classical Christian frame, aligning with the traditional classical objective of formation rather than mere information transfer.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords (from the Six Essential Elements) include formation, virtue, telos, pursuit of truth/goodness/beauty, and liberal education. The Trinity materials emphasize formation and virtue in a Christian classical context, which aligns with those terms. The materials explicitly emphasize formation of character and virtue. - Direct references to “liberal education,” “paideia,” and “great

conversation” are not always explicit in public materials, but the overarching framing of formation and virtue within a classical-Christian mission is present.

Why this rating - The school publicly articulates formation and virtue as central aims, with Christ-centered classical framing. This strongly supports a CLASSICAL designation for Element 2, given the alignment with formation-as-tundra rather than an information-only mindset.

Citations - Capital Campaign language and formation framing.

### **Element 3: Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL**

Evidence - Public materials describe Trinity as Central Kentucky’s “premier classical Christian private day school,” signaling a classical curriculum orientation. This signals intent and philosophy but does not consistently spell out the technical curricular elements (e.g., the Trivium/Quadrivium, Great Books, or explicit Great Conversation practices) in the site copy itself. - The school’s materials emphasize a classical identity rather than a fully explicit Great Books or liberal-arts curriculum listing on the site; this leaves room for a classical orientation but with incomplete documentation of the canonical elements. The absence of clear Great Books/Great Conversation language in the public-facing pages is a notable gap in full documentation of the Classic Curriculum.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators (Six Essential Elements) include Seven Liberal Arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Great Books, Great Conversation, and integration of the liberal arts across the curriculum. The Trinity materials explicitly identify the school as classical Christian, but explicit mentions of the seven liberal arts, Great Books, or a trifold Trivium/Quadrivium sequence are not consistently visible in the public pages reviewed. This yields a partial alignment with the curriculum keywords, but not a fully explicit documentation. - Negative indicators would include “STEM-first framing,” “project-based learning dominance,” or “social studies terminology replacing history.” The Trinity site does not foreground these negative signs; however, their absence of explicit Great Books/Trivium documentation lowers category 3 from CLASSICAL to SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Why this rating - The “classical” label is present in the school’s identity, but explicit curricular articulation of Great Books, Trivium/Quadrivium, Latin/Greek, or explicit Great Conversation pedagogy is not consistently spelled out on the public site. This supports a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating for Element 3.

Citations - Classical Christian identity and general curriculum framing.

### **Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — NOT CLASSICAL**

Evidence - Public materials do not consistently describe the core pedagogical methods central to classical education (Socratic seminars, dialectic, rigorous rhetoric instruction, memory work, or scholé days). The site emphasizes formation, virtue, and character, but does not provide explicit, category-contained evidence of Socratic dialogue, large-scale Socratic seminars, or upper-school rhetoric training in the public-facing materials. This lack of explicit classical pedagogy documentation is a key determinant for NOT CLASSICAL in this rubric.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive pedagogical keywords (from the Six Essential Elements) include Socratic seminar, dialogue, memorization/recitation, scholé (restful learning), and rhetoric instruction. The Trinity materials do not consistently showcase these teaching methods; the public-facing pages do not present a robust, documented pedagogy aligned with the classical method, which yields a low positive keyword signal in this category and aligns with NOT CLASSICAL status for Element 4. - Negative keywords in the document emphasize experiential learning, project-based-only approaches, or student-directed pedagogy that undermines classical methodology. While the Trinity site emphasizes formation and virtue rather than project-based extremes, the lack of explicit classical pedagogy documentation supports the NOT CLASSICAL designation.

Why this rating - Without explicit evidence of Socratic pedagogy, memory work, or formal rhetoric training as a sustained, documented approach, Element 4 does not meet the rubric for a Classical pedagogy.

Citations - General pedagogical framing (no explicit classical pedagogy on public pages).

### **Element 5: Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL**

Evidence - The school features faculty pages and named faculty members, indicating a traditional, relational faculty environment. The presence of named staff and faculty profiles (e.g., Becky Nelson, Ed Hardin) suggests a model of teachers as mentors and living curriculum, even if the public site doesn't explicitly declare the "living curriculum" phrase. This signals potential alignment with certain classical expectations, but documentation of a formal "living curriculum" approach or explicit faculty formation programs is not consistently cited in the public materials.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords for Element 5 include model teachers, mentors, living curriculum, portrait of a teacher, and a collegial culture. The Trinity materials show faculty pages and profiles and a culture of teachers as part of the school fabric, but explicit language about "living curriculum" or explicit faculty formation processes is not consistently documented in the public-facing content. The presence of teacher profiles and a traditional staff culture provides partial alignment with the classical faculty model, which yields a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL designation. - Negative signals would include "facilitators/guides on the side" or "certification-driven jargon without classical context." The available content does not strongly signal these negative aspects.

Why this rating - The existence of multiple faculty profiles and the visible faith-driven/ministry orientation suggest the faculty role is valued in the classical sense, but the lack of explicit living-curriculum language and formal classical-faculty development documentation reduces Element 5 to SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Citations - Faculty profiles and staff references (public site materials).

### **Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL**

Evidence - The school emphasizes partnership with families, parent formation opportunities, and open campus policies. The Trinity site includes parent-facing resources, admissions steps, and references to parent involvement through events (Open Houses, parent panels, and family communications). The public-facing materials indicate collaboration with families and an environment that invites parental participation, which aligns with the classical model's emphasis on parents as co-educators and the broader community formation.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords from the Six Essential Elements for Element 6 include "Partnership with Families," "co-teachers," "parent formation," "open campus," and "parent involvement." The Trinity materials clearly indicate partnership with families, opportunities for parent involvement, and open-campus interactions. This aligns well with the positive indicators. - The public materials also show parent-facing handbooks and family guides (as part of the Trinity Lex site) and a culture of parent engagement (e.g., parent resources, open tours, and book/gathering events). These signals map to the positive keyword indicators.

Why this rating - The school demonstrates a strong parental-partnership orientation and community involvement, meeting the core classical category expectations for Parents & Community.

Citations - Family partnership and parent involvement language (Capital Campaign and admissions content).

### **What Would Move the Needle**

- If this school seeks to become CLASSICAL across all six categories, it should explicitly document and publish:
- Curriculum with explicit Great Books, Trivium/Quadrivium alignment, and a clear Great Conversation framework (Element 3).
- Pedagogy with explicit Socratic seminars, memory work, and Scholé-inspired contemplative days (Element 4).

- A defined “living curriculum” approach with faculty development programs and explicit teacher-formation language (Element 5).
- Increased explicit liturgical practices or liturgical-year integration (Element 1).
- Additional explicit articulation of “truth, goodness, beauty” as core transcendental aims (Element 1) and expansion of theology integration across disciplines (Element 1).
- Strengthen textual alignment with the classical keywords by incorporating explicit language such as “great books,” “Socratic dialogue,” “Scholé days,” and “Trivium/Quadrivium” across curriculum and marketing materials, not only in internal documents.

## Appendix

### ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

### Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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